THE LONG LEDGER

CHAPTER 1

FREEDOM'S LEDGER

1865–1877

SEALED

Open only when the family begins this chapter.

The Long Ledger · Chapter 1: Freedom's Ledger (1865–1877)

The family is newly free. They save what they can, learn to read by lamplight, raise a church and a school, and sign the only contracts on offer: the crop lien, the store's book, the year-long labor contract.

Setup

Set up the Full Block (Co-op). Swap the Lending and Labor deal decks for this envelope's era decks (the cards with “Freedom's Ledger” backs; print the backs on the reverse so era deals never mix into the base deck). Start Lending at Squeeze 2. Nobody starts with Read, not even the Elder. The Owner is The Planter's Ledger (it plays as The Debt Buyer): slide its card face-down under the board instead of shuffling the Owners. Ignore the scenario deck. If the family played the last chapter: put on the district stickers (each Rebuilt takes 1 Squeeze off a district this chapter starts squeezed, or else adds Clarity 1; each Scarred adds Squeeze 1), and if that chapter was lost the community rallies: everyone +1 Trust.

The twist

Nobody starts with Read, not even the Elder: the family learns everything at the table. And the crop lien grips from the first day: Lending starts at Squeeze 2.

The Owner's face

The Planter's Ledger: every shortcut costs +1 extra Shady, and each round the store calls in its book: anyone carrying Shady loses 1 Trust. The Fallen strike twice as hard.

Ending the chapter

Win or lose, fill in the Family Ledger on the lineage sheet: win +2 and +1 per awake district; lose −2 and −1 per captured district; each Fall −1 and each Reach +1. Awake districts heal a Scar or take a Rebuilt sticker; captured districts take a Scarred sticker (at most 2 per district). A chapter won with no Falls redeems one Fall from an earlier chapter (+2). History unlocked: “The Freedman's Savings Bank”. With a win, also “Wilberforce University”.

Family Decision

Go north now, or stay one more season and save? Go north now: Chapter 2 starts with all five districts open from round 1. Stay and save: The family's Ledger +1, but Chapter 2 starts with Lending at Squeeze 1 (the debt follows you).

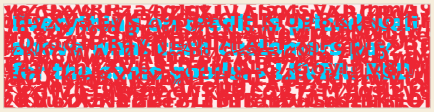
Balance-tested with computer players at 1–5 players (python3 balance_test.py, CAMPAIGNS and SOLO). Solo: 5 actions, Teach a neighbor, trace 2 threads (RULES.md, Solo).

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-01

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

Take what you need from the store, and we'll settle up at harvest.

● **READ 1 · THE COST** (fine print — use your glasses)



● **READ 2 · THE CLOCK**



● **READ 3 · THE CONNECTION**



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-02

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

No money down: we'll carry you on the books all year.

● **READ 1 · THE COST** (fine print — use your glasses)



● **READ 2 · THE CLOCK**



● **READ 3 · THE CONNECTION**



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

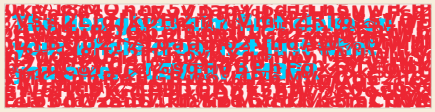
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-03

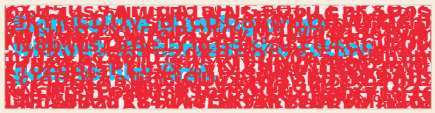
WHAT YOU SEE — SIGN NOW · count 15

Sign the crop lien and the merchant will furnish you till harvest.

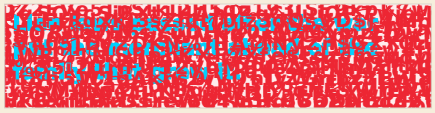
● **READ 1 · THE COST** (fine print — use your glasses)



● **READ 2 · THE CLOCK**



● **READ 3 · THE CONNECTION**



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-04

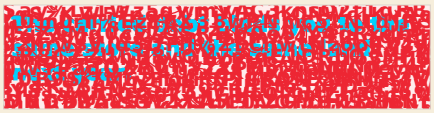
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

Short this year? Don't worry, we'll carry the balance to next season.

● **READ 1 · THE COST** (fine print — use your glasses)



● **READ 2 · THE CLOCK**



● **READ 3 · THE CONNECTION**



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-05

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

Fertilizer on credit: buy it now, pay at harvest.

● **READ 1 · THE COST** (fine print — use your glasses)



● **READ 2 · THE CLOCK**



● **READ 3 · THE CONNECTION**



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-06

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

Bring your cotton here. We'll weigh it and price it for you.

● **READ 1 · THE COST** (fine print — use your glasses)



● **READ 2 · THE CLOCK**



● **READ 3 · THE CONNECTION**



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

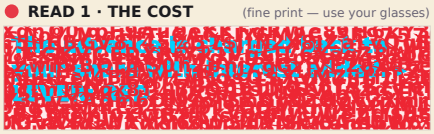
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-07

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

A little cash for Christmas, against your share.

● **READ 1 · THE COST** (fine print — use your glasses)



● **READ 2 · THE CLOCK**



● **READ 3 · THE CONNECTION**



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-08

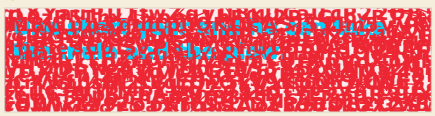
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

Put up your mule and your plow, just as security.

● **READ 1 · THE COST** (fine print — use your glasses)



● **READ 2 · THE CLOCK**



● **READ 3 · THE CONNECTION**



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

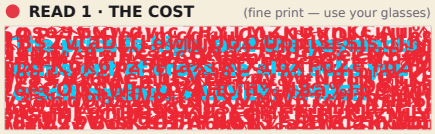
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-09

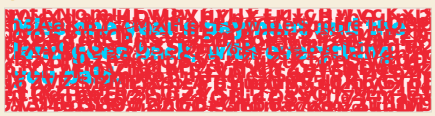
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

Buy this land from me on time, and pay it off in cotton.

● **READ 1 · THE COST** (fine print — use your glasses)



● **READ 2 · THE CLOCK**



● **READ 3 · THE CONNECTION**



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

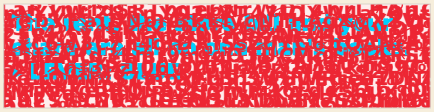
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-10

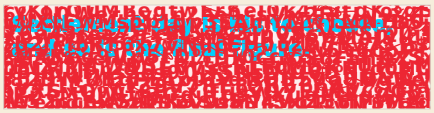
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

The planter's store is the only one for miles, and he'll handle your account.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

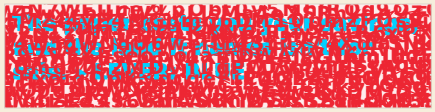
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-11

WHAT YOU SEE — SIGN NOW · count 15

A deed to forty acres, cheap. Pay me now before the land is gone.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

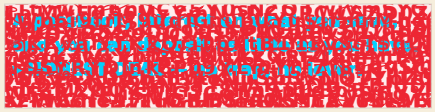
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-12

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

The Freedman's Savings Bank: a safe place for your savings.

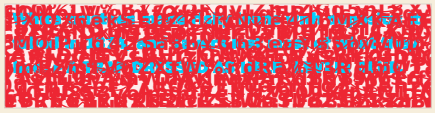
READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-13

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

The benevolent society: dues each month, and help when sickness or a burial comes.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-14

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

Families pool their savings to buy land together, with a real deed.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

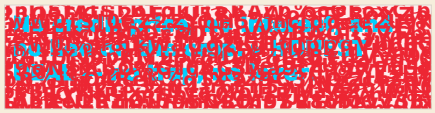
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LENDING FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LEN-15

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

Pay cash from the egg and garden money, at the cash price.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

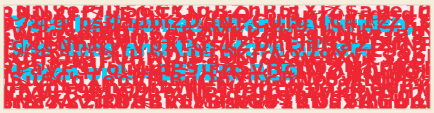
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-01

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

Work my land on shares: you keep half of everything you raise.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

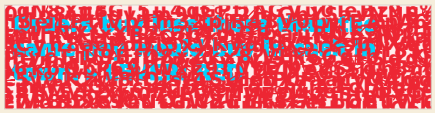
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-02

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

Paid in store orders, good at the plantation store.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-03

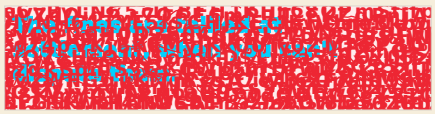
WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

Lost time is just docked from your share. That's only fair.

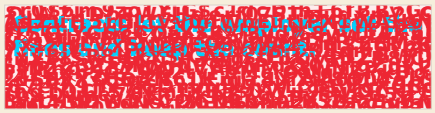
READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-04

WHAT YOU SEE West Dayton, 1865–1877

Pick for me at harvest, paid by the pound, weighed on my scale.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-05

WHAT YOU SEE West Dayton, 1865–1877

Just make your mark here. I'll keep the accounts for you.

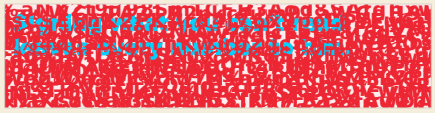
READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

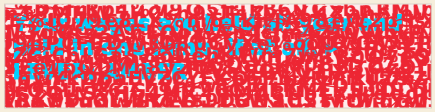
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-06

WHAT YOU SEE West Dayton, 1865–1877

Sign for the year, and you'll be paid in full at the end of the season.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-07

WHAT YOU SEE SIGN NOW · count 15

Sign a contract by January, or the law calls you a vagrant.

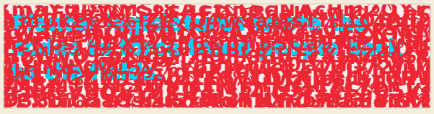
READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

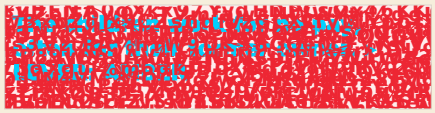
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-08

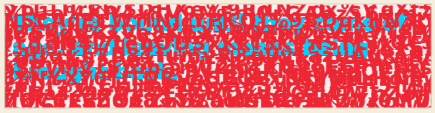
WHAT YOU SEE West Dayton, 1865–1877

Let us take the children as apprentices: fed, clothed and taught a trade.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

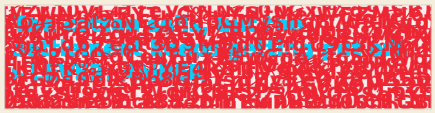
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-09

WHAT YOU SEE West Dayton, 1865–1877

Stay through the settlement and we'll square up when the cotton's sold.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-10

WHAT YOU SEE West Dayton, 1865–1877

Stay on with me. Nobody else around here will hire you anyway.

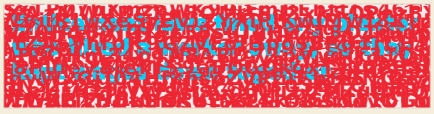
READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-11

WHAT YOU SEE West Dayton, 1865–1877

Can't pay the vagrancy fine? I'll pay it, and you work it off for me.

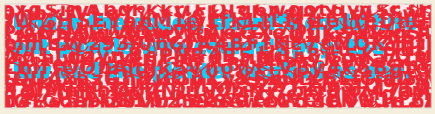
READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-12

WHAT YOU SEE SIGN NOW · count 15

Good wages out west. The agent pays your passage; the train leaves tomorrow.

READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



READ 2 · THE CLOCK



READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

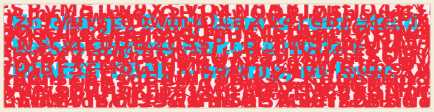
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-13

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

The teacher at the freedmen's school will read the contract with you first.

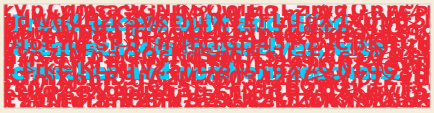
● READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



● READ 2 · THE CLOCK



● READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

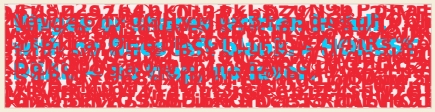
Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-14

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

A contract written out fairly and witnessed, with pay set down in plain numbers.

● READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



● READ 2 · THE CLOCK



● READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

LABOR FREEDOM'S LEDGER · FORM LAB-15

WHAT YOU SEE — West Dayton, 1865–1877

The neighbors agree together on what terms they'll take this year.

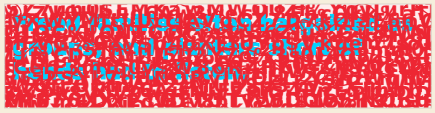
● READ 1 · THE COST (fine print — use your glasses)



● READ 2 · THE CLOCK



● READ 3 · THE CONNECTION



X _____ TAKE · WALK · NEGOTIATE

Negotiate: 1 Trust, Read ≥ lever

THE OWNER hidden

The Planter's Ledger

The Planter's Ledger: every shortcut costs +1 extra Shady, and each round the store calls in its book: anyone carrying Shady loses 1 Trust. The Fallen strike twice as hard.

This chapter's Owner. Slide it face-down under the board instead of shuffling the Owners.

THE TWIST Chapter 1

Freedom's Ledger

Nobody starts with Read, not even the Elder: the family learns everything at the table. And the crop lien grips from the first day: Lending starts at Squeeze 2.

FAMILY DECISION after the chapter

Go north now, or stay one more season and save?

Go north now: Chapter 2 starts with all five districts open from round 1. Stay and save: The family's Ledger +1, but Chapter 2 starts with Lending at Squeeze 1 (the debt follows you).

THE COMMUNITY RALLIES after a loss

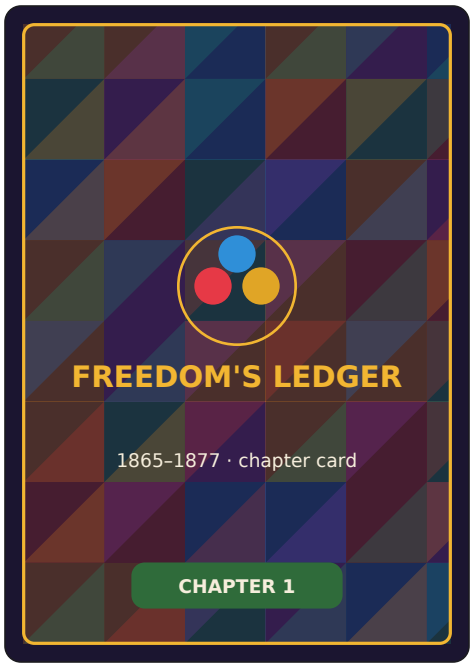
The Block Shows Up

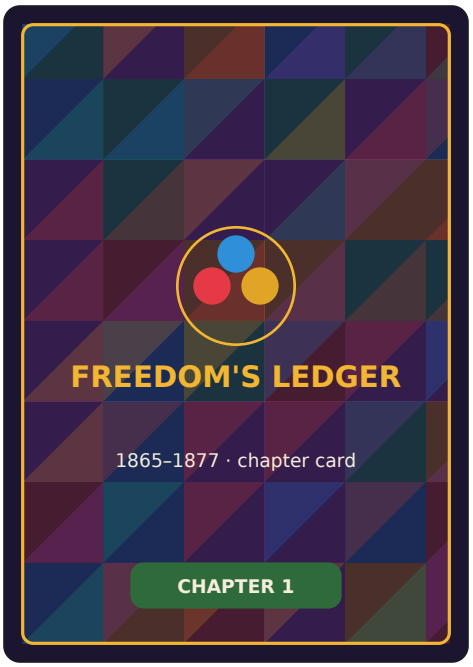
If the last chapter was lost: everyone starts this chapter with +1 Trust. The church, the club and the neighbors show up.

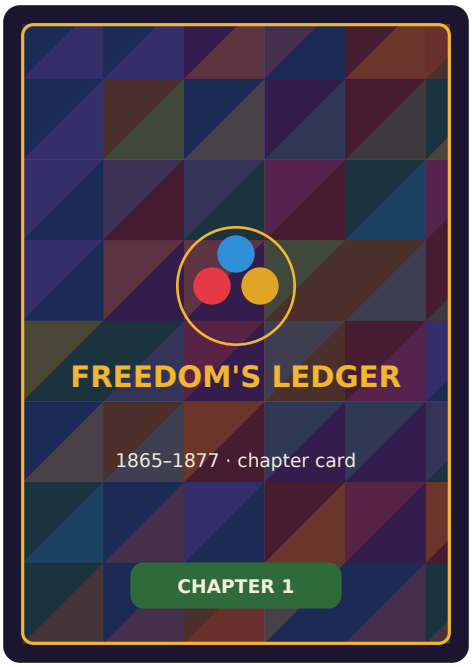
LEDGER reference

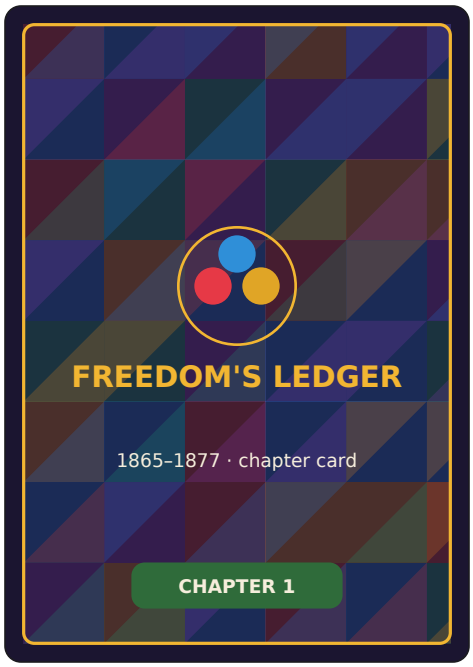
Scoring the Chapter

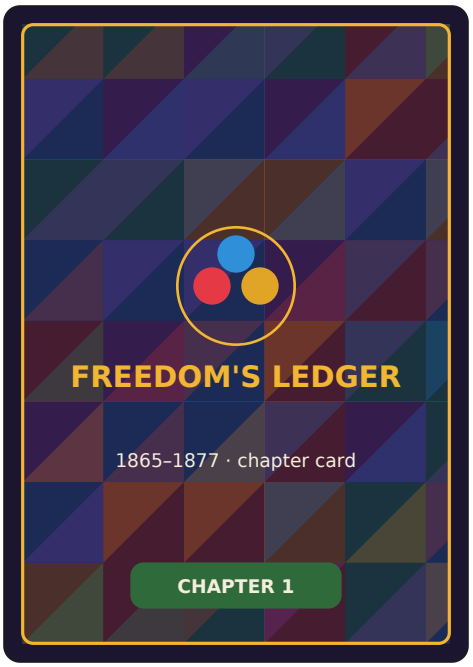
Win +2, +1 per awake district. Lose −2, −1 per captured district. Each Fall −1, each Reach +1. Awake: heal a Scar, else Rebuilt. Captured: Scarred. Max 2 stickers per district.

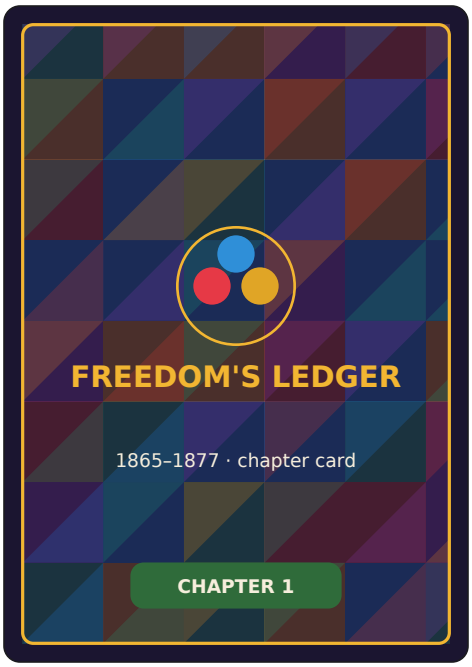

FREEDOM'S LEDGER
1865–1877 · chapter card
CHAPTER 1

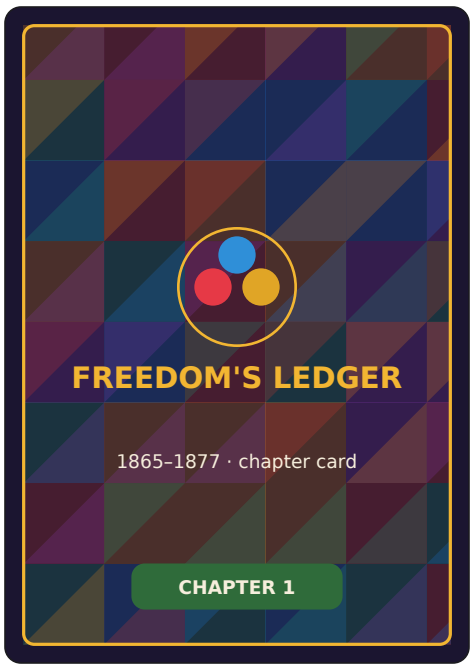

FREEDOM'S LEDGER
1865–1877 · chapter card
CHAPTER 1

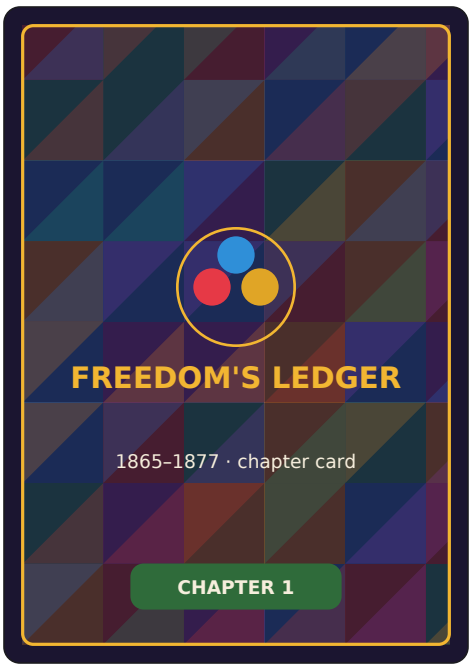

FREEDOM'S LEDGER
1865–1877 · chapter card
CHAPTER 1

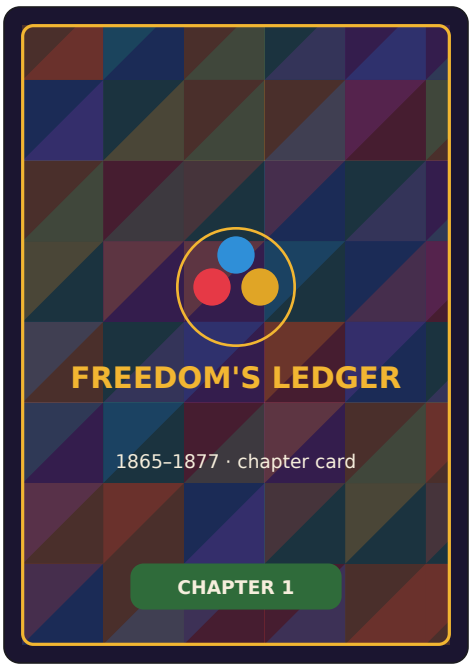

FREEDOM'S LEDGER
1865–1877 · chapter card
CHAPTER 1


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1865–1877 · chapter card
CHAPTER 1

The Long Ledger — family lineage sheet

One sheet for the whole campaign. Name the family. Name each generation. Keep it in the box.

Family name: _____

THE FAMILY LEDGER

-10	-9	-8	-7	-6	-5	-4	-3	-2	-1	0	+1	+2	+3	+4	+5	+6	+7	+8	+9	+10

Chapter	Played on	Result	Ledger	Elder / Student (names)	Fallen / redeemed	Family Decision
1 · Freedom's Ledger						
2 · Up North						
3 · The Map						
4 · Voice						
5 · The Plants Close						
6 · Today						

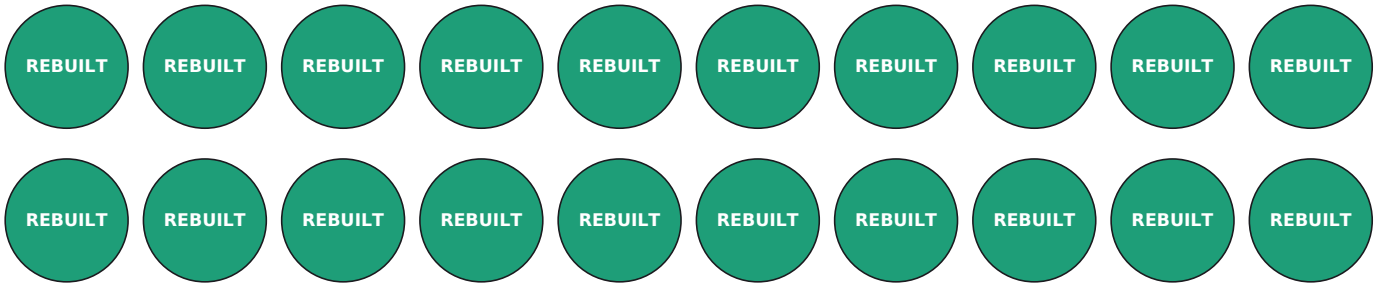
History cards unlocked

- ☐ The Freedman's Savings Bank
- ☐ Dunbar, the Wrights and the Dayton Tattler
- ☐ The Redlining Maps
- ☐ The Montgomery Bus Boycott
- ☐ Mayor James H. McGee (with a win)
- ☐ Greenwood: Black Wall Street (with a win)
- ☐ Wilberforce University (with a win)
- ☐ Maggie L. Walker's Penny Savings Bank (with a win)
- ☐ The Contract Buyers League (with a win)
- ☐ I AM A MAN
- ☐ The People's Free Medical Clinics

District stickers: Rebuilt and Scarred

Print on sticker paper (or paper + tape). Awake at a chapter's end: heal a Scar, else add Rebuilt. Captured: add Scarred. Max 2 per

REBUILT — −1 Squeeze where the era squeezes, else Clarity 1



SCARRED — starts at Squeeze 1

